

30-Dec-2024
Date: _____

Honorable Dr. Mohammed Amin Adam
Minister of Finance
Ministry of Finance
Republic of Ghana

Honorable Minister:

**Re: TF No. TF0C6881
TF No. TF0C6868
(Additional Financing to the Ghana Accountability for Learning Outcomes Project)
Additional Instructions: Disbursement and Financial Information Letter**

I refer to the Grant Agreements (“Agreement”) between The Republic of Ghana (“Recipient”) and the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development/International Development Association (“Bank”), acting as Grant Agent for the Global Partnership for Education Fund and jointly as administrator of the Early Learning Partnership Multi-Donor Trust Fund, for the above-referenced project. The Standard Conditions, as defined in the Grant Agreements, provide that the Recipient may, from time to time, request withdrawals of Grant amounts from the Grant accounts in accordance with the Disbursement and Financial Information Letter (“DFIL”), and such additional instructions as the Bank may specify from time to time by notice to the Recipient. The Standard Conditions also provide that the Disbursement and Financial Information Letter may set out Project specific financial reporting requirements. This letter constitutes such Disbursement and Financial Information Letter and may be revised from time to time.

I. Disbursement Arrangements, Withdrawal of Grant Funds, and Reporting of Uses of Grant Funds

The *Disbursement Guidelines for Investment Project Financing*, dated February 2017 (“Disbursement Guidelines”), are available on the Bank’s public website at <https://www.worldbank.org> and are an integral part of the Disbursement and Financial Information Letter. The manner in which the provisions in the Disbursement Guidelines apply to the Grants is specified below.

(i) Disbursement Arrangements

The table in **Schedule 1** provides the disbursement methods^{a/} which may be used by the Recipient, information on registration of authorized signatories^{b/}, processing of Withdrawal Applications (including the minimum value of applications and advances), instructions on supporting documentation, and frequency of reporting on the Designated Account(s).

(ii) Withdrawal Applications (Electronic Delivery)

The Recipient shall deliver Withdrawal Applications (with supporting documents, “Applications”) electronically through the Bank’s web-based portal “Client Connection” at <https://clientconnection.worldbank.org>. This option will be effective after the officials designated in writing by the Recipient, who are authorized to sign and deliver Applications, have registered as users of “Client Connection.” The designated officials shall deliver Applications electronically by completing Form 2380, which is accessible through “Client Connection.” By signing the Authorized Signatory Letter, which can

be delivered manually or electronically, the Recipient confirms that it is authorizing such persons to accept Secure Identification Credentials (SIDC) and to deliver the Applications and supporting documents to the Bank by these means. The Recipient may exercise the option of preparing and delivering Applications in paper form on exceptional cases (including those where the Recipient encounters legal limitations) and which were previously agreed with the Bank. By designating officials to use SIDC and deliver the Applications electronically, the Recipient confirms through the Authorized Signatory Letter its agreement to (a) abide by the Terms and Conditions of Use of Secure Identification Credentials in connection with the Use of Electronic Means to Process Applications and Supporting Documentation, available in the Bank's public website at <https://www.worldbank.org> and "Client Connection" at <https://clientconnection.worldbank.org>; and (b) to cause such officials to abide by those terms and conditions.

II. Financial Reports and Audits

(i) Financial Reports

The Recipient shall prepare and furnish to the Bank not later than forty-five (45) days after the end of each calendar quarter interim unaudited financial reports ("IFRs") for the Project covering the quarter.

- **Audits**

Each audit of the Financial Statements shall cover the period of one (1) fiscal year of the Recipient, commencing with the fiscal year in which the first withdrawal was made. The audited Financial Statements for each such period shall be furnished to the Bank by the Recipient through MoE not later than six (6) months after the end of such period.

III. Other Important Information

For additional information on disbursement arrangements, please refer to the Loan Handbook available on the Bank's public website at <https://www.worldbank.org> and "Client Connection" at <https://clientconnection.worldbank.org>, the Bank recommends that you register as a user of "Client Connection." From this website, you will be able to prepare and deliver Applications, monitor the near real-time status of the Grants, and retrieve related policy, financial, and procurement information. For more information about the website and registration arrangements, or if you have any queries in relation to the above, please contact the Bank by email at askloans@worldbank.org using the above reference.

Yours sincerely,



Robert Taliencio
Acting Country Director for Ghana, Liberia and Sierra Leone
Western and Central Africa Region

Attachments

- a) Form of Authorized Signatory Letter
- b) Interim unaudited Financial Report (IFR)

^{a/}With copies: Ms. Eva Mends
Chief Director
Ministry of Finance
Republic of Ghana

Schedule 1: Disbursement Provisions

Basic Information					
Grant No. Grant No.	TF0C6881 TF0C6868	Country	Republic of Ghana	Closing Date	Section III.B.3 of Schedule of AF Grant agreements.
		Recipient	Republic of Ghana		
		Name of the Project	Additional Financing to the Ghana Accountability for Learning Outcomes Project	Disbursement Deadline Date	Four (4) months after the closing date
Disbursement Methods and Supporting Documentation					
Disbursement Methods	Methods	Supporting Documentation			
Direct Payment	Yes	Copy of records			
Reimbursement	Yes	Interim Financial Reports (IFRs) in the format provided in Attachment 2 of the DFIL for all sources of Financing and refer to “additional information” section for more details on PBCs eligible expenditures.			
Advance (into a Designated Account)	Yes				
Special Commitments	Yes	Copy of Letter of Credit			
Designated Account					
Type	One pooled designated account, managed by the MOE for all eligible expenditures – same as existing parent projects			Ceiling	Variable
Financial Institution - Name	Bank of Ghana			Currency	USD
Frequency of Reporting	Quarterly			Amount	“ Two quarters forecast as per IFRs”
Minimum Value of Applications (subsection 3.5)					
The minimum value of applications for Reimbursement, Direct Payment and Special Commitment is USD 100,000 equivalent.					
Authorized Signatures					
Withdrawal and Documentation Applications					
The form for Authorized Signatories Letter is provided in Attachment 1 of this letter					
The form for Authorized Signatory Letter is provided in Attachment 1 of this letter.					
The ASL and all Withdrawal Applications with their supporting documentation will be submitted electronically via the Bank’s “Client Connection” system.					
Additional Information					
1. The recipient will also open an operational account denominated in Ghanaian cedi (GHS) for payments denominated in GHS at an Institution acceptable to the Association.					
2. PBC linked categories (Category 1), the following is required for disbursements:					
• Please refer to the PBC related withdrawal Condition(s) in the Legal Agreement (B.1(b) and B.2)					
• Confirmation notice by the Association that (i) one or more PBC (s) (as referred to in Annex of the Grant Agreement Annex) have been achieved and verified according to the verification protocol set in the PBC Manual and (ii) indicating amounts pertaining to such PBC(s).					
• For financing eligible expenditures under this category, the Recipient has furnished evidence satisfactory to the Association that (i) Eligible PBC expenditures have been made and verified in accordance with the relevant provisions of the Financing Agreement Section III.B by the entity					

appointed in the PBC Manual and that (ii) the relevant PBC(s) has/have been achieved and in accordance with the verification protocol and verified by the verification agent

- For documentation of such eligible expenditure, the Lesser of (i) Eligible PBC expenditures reported in the IFR (as verified by the entity appointed in the PBC manual) or (ii) the amounts confirmed by the Association based on the report issued by the verification agent pertaining to PBCs which have been achieved, and verified by the verification agent in accordance with the PBC Manual, and documented in the ‘Summary of PBCs reported and achieved & PBC related eligible expenditure’ (on cumulative basis).
- Dully completed summary of PBCs reported and achieved & PBC related eligible expenditure (Attachment 2 of the DFIL)
- Note that if advances are used to financed PBC expenditures, upon achievement of the PBC, there will not be a reimbursement, but only a documentation in Client Connection
- In case PBC expenditures are pre-financed by the Recipient, upon achievement of the PBC, the lesser of the PBC value and the underlying expenditure will be reimbursed.

Other

3. For disbursements under Category 6 of the Withdrawal Table (Contingent Emergency Response Component: CERC):

- Supporting documentation requirements for reporting on use of Financing proceeds under this category would be provided in a revised DFIL, if CERC is activated under the project and funds are allocated to the category.
- In order to provide necessary liquidity for fast response, the ceiling of the Designated Account could be increased temporarily before the DFIL is revised to include provisions of an Advance.

Attachment 1 – Form of Authorized Signatory Letter

Form of Authorized Signatory Letter

[Letterhead]

Ministry of Finance

[Street address]

[City] [Country]

[DATE]

The World Bank
1818 H Street, N.W.
Washington, D.C. 20433
United States of America

Attention: [Country Director] ¹

Dear [Country Director]:

Re: Grant No. _____ (name of Project)

I refer to the Grant Letter Agreement (“Agreement”) between the [International Bank for Reconstruction and Development/International Development Association] (“[Bank]”), acting as [*an implementing agency of the Global Environmental Facility*] [*administrator of the Global Partnership on Output-based Aid*] [*administrator of the name of the trust fund*], and [*name of recipient*] (the “Recipient”), providing the above Grant. For the purposes of Section 3.04 (b) of the Standard Conditions, as defined in the Agreement, any [²one] of the persons whose authenticated specimen signatures appear below is authorized on behalf of the Recipient to sign applications for withdrawal [and applications for a special commitment] under this Grant.

For the purpose of delivering Applications to the Bank, ³[each] of the persons whose authenticated specimen signatures appears below is authorized on behalf of the Recipient, acting ⁴[individually] ⁵[jointly], to deliver Applications and evidence in support thereof on the terms and conditions specified by the Bank.

⁶[This confirms that the Recipient is authorizing such persons to accept Secure Identification Credentials (SIDC) and to deliver the Applications and supporting documents to the Bank by electronic means. In full recognition that the Bank shall rely upon such representations and warranties, including without limitation, the representations and warranties contained in the *Terms and Conditions of Use of Secure Identification Credentials in connection with Use of Electronic Means to Process Applications and Supporting Documentation* (“Terms and Conditions of Use of SIDC”), the Recipient represents and warrants to the Bank that it will cause such persons to abide by those terms and conditions.]

This Authorization replaces and supersedes any Authorization currently in the Bank records with respect to this Agreement.

[Name], [position]

Specimen Signature: _____

[Name], [position]

Specimen Signature: _____

[Name], [position]

Specimen Signature: _____

Yours truly,

/ signed /

[Position]⁷

Attachment 2 – Interim unaudited Financial Statements

P165557 - Ghana Accountability for Learning Outcomes Project(GALOP) - IDA XXXX, TFXXXX

Interim Financial Report - Component Component 5 - Results Based Financing

Project Expenditure Spending Report For the Period Ending.....

PART I

Advances Requested By Borrower : Componnet 1-3(excluding 2.4)

Cumulative Advances												
Project Expenditure	CoA Code	Budgeted Data	IDA Share capped				IDA Cumulative to Date		GPE Share			GPE Cumulative to Date
		GHC	GHC (Equiv.)	Exchange Rate	USD	GHC (Equiv.)	USD	GHC (Equiv.)	Exchange Rate	USD	GHC (Equiv.)	USD
Expenditure Elements under Component 1 - 3 (excluding 2.4):												
Compensation of Employees (Basic Education Basic Salaries) - KG	02302001-2111001											
Compensation of Employees (Basic Education Basic Salaries) - PRIMARY	02302002-2111001											
Compensation of Employees (Basic Education Basic Salaries) - JHS	02302003-2111001											
TOTAL UNDER COMPONENT 1-3(excluding 2.4)												
CUMMULATIVE ADVANCES DOCUMENTED DATE												
OUTSTANDING ADVANCES TO BE DOCUMENTED												

Advances Requested By Borrower Componnet 5

		GPE COVID Share						
Project Expenditure	CoA Code	Budgeted Data	GPE COVID Share				GPE COVID Cumulative to Date	
		GHC	GHC (Equiv.)	Exchange Rate	USD	GHC (Equiv.)	USD	
Expenditure Elements under Component 5:								
Goods (Materials and Office Supplies)	2210100							
Works (Non-Financial Asset/Non-residential dwellings)	3111200							
Consulting Services	2210800							
TOTAL UNDER COMPONENT 5								
CUMMULATIVE ADVANCES DOCUMENTED DATE								
OUTSTANDING ADVANCES TO BE DOCUMENTED								

PART II

Documentation of Previous Advances (Upon Verification of DLRs) :Componnet 1-3(excluding 2.4)

Documentation of Advances for the Year												
Project Expenditure	CoA Code	Actualised Exp (A)	IDA Share (capped)				GPE Share			GPE Cumulative to Date		
		GHC	GHC (Equiv.)	Exchange Rate	USD	GHC (Equiv.)	USD	GHC (Equiv.)	Exchange Rate	USD	GHC (Equiv.)	USD
<u>Expenditure Elements:</u>												
Compensation of Employees (Basic Education Basic Salaries) - KG	02302001-2111001											
Compensation of Employees (Basic Education Basic Salaries) - PRIMARY	02302002-2111001											
Compensation of Employees (Basic Education Basic Salaries) - JHS	02302003-2111001											
Total Value of DLRs Achieved now Documented												
Amount Advanced not yet documented												
Outstanding Undocumented Advances												

Documentation of Previous Advances (Upon Verification of DLRs) :Componnet 5

		GPE COVID Share						
Project Expenditure	CoA Code	Budgeted Data	GPE COVID Share				GPE COVID Cumulative to Date	
		GHC	GHC (Equiv.)	Exchange Rate	USD	GHC (Equiv.)	USD	
Expenditure Elements under Component 5:								
Goods (Materials and Office Supplies)	2210100							
Works (Non-Financial Asset/Non-residential dwellings)	3111200							
Consulting Services	2210800							
Total Value of DLRs Achieved now Documented								
Amount Advanced not yet documented								
Outstanding Undocumented Advances								

PART III

Cumulative Status of Withdrawal Application Including Advances and Documentation

Description/Application Number	Date of Submission	Value Date	Amount (USD)	Cummulative	Notes

Certified by:

Director of Finance (MoE)

Project Coordinator/ Director

Date:

Date:

Notes

The IFR is required to be submitted at least twice a year.

Actualised expenditure refers to the actual verified amount paid by the Govt, for the preceeding year by way of the project expenditure

List of PBCs achieved and verified

PBCs	XDR Amount allocated as per FA	Current quarter - PBCs achieved	Current quarter - PBCs Verified	Total Value of DLR Earned in Reporting Period XDR	Exchange Rate (XDR/USD)	Equivalent Amount to be Paid in WA	Cummulative amount disbursed under this PBC to date	Amount avaialble for future disbursements
1								
2								
3								
4								
5								
6								
7								
8								
9								
10								
11								
12								
13								
14								
15								
16								
17								
18								
19								

Designated Account Activity Statement in US Dollars
for the Six Months Period ending.....

Project Name:

IDA Loan No.:

Bank and Account No.:

	IDA	GPE	GPRBA
Part I			
1. Cumulative advances to end of current reporting period			
2. Cumulative expenditures to end of last reporting period			
3. Outstanding advances to be accounted (1-2)	-	-	-
Part II			
4. Opening DA balance at beginning of reporting period			
5. Add/Subtract: Cumulative adjustments, including interest earned, (if any)			
6. Advances from the World Bank during reporting period			
7. add 5 and 6			
8. Outstanding advances to be accounted for (4+7)			
9. Closing DA balance at end of current reporting (as of DD/MM/YYYY)			
10. Add/subtract; cumulative adjustment (if any)			
11. Expenditures for current reporting period, total from Financial Report			
12. Add 10+11			
13. Add 9+11			
14. Difference (if any) 8-13			
Part III			
15. Total Forecasted amount to be paid by World Bank			
16. Less: Closing DA balance after adjustment			
17. Direct payments/ SC payments (if any)			
18. Add 16+17			
19. Cash requirement from WB for next 6 months (15-18)	-	-	-
Approved by:			